

KILLER CLAWS

DAKOTARAPTOR

With its large “killer claw,” *Dakotaraptor* stalked the Late Cretaceous plains of what is now North America. This formidable predator had large wings, which may have helped it balance itself when lifting its feet, ready to pin its prey beneath its sharp claws. Paleontologists think that *Dakotaraptor* probably competed with younger tyrannosaurids for food. Its fossils, which were first found in the Hell Creek Formation in the US, tell us that this mid-sized hunter probably came somewhere between the tiny maniraptorans and the gigantic *Tyrannosaurus* on the predator food chain.

Dakotaraptor was probably covered in feathers, perhaps to keep it warm or for display.



***Dakotaraptor* is named after the state of South Dakota, where its fossils were first found.**

STATS AND FACTS

After studying fossils of *Dakotaraptor*'s limbs, paleontologists have come to believe it was a fast runner that might have chased down small prey. However, they are unsure whether or not *Dakotaraptor* hunted in packs.

WEIGHT



An adult *Dakotaraptor* could weigh up to 825 lb (374 kg).

FEATHERS



Ten small ridges were found on one of *Dakotaraptor*'s arm bones. These ridges, called quill knobs, are where large feathers were probably attached to its tissues.